

Thou shalt see!

People who are completely blind will now be able to see—thanks to technology, which has made artificial retinas possible. Optobionics, based in Illinois, USA, is the company behind the Artificial Silicon Retina (ASR). These solar powered microchips are smaller than a pin's head and are less than half the thickness of a sheet of paper. The chips are surgically implanted behind the patient's retina. It functions by converting the light coming into the eye into electrical impulses, which are then used to stimulate the nerve fibre layers to provide vision. This is very much like the actual operation of the human retina.

ASRs are helpful in treating untreatable forms of blindness such as retinitis pigmentosa and macular degeneration. During clinical trials, doctors were able to restore the eyesight of six patients, who've gained partial vision without any side effects.

A wrap-around PDA

This one is specially for all you PDA users.

Fossil's Wrist PDA is a wrist watch that can hook up to your Palm PDA (the Pocket PC version is coming out later this year) via the IR port and carry information such as appointments, to do lists, contacts, and so on in addition to displaying the time and date. It can also



receive up to 20 business cards from other Wrist PDAs and regular PDAs. The Wrist PDA has 190 KB of main memory and is water resistant to a depth of 30 metres. But at \$145 (approx Rs 7,250), it's priced on the higher side. Given the price and its dependence on a handheld, it remains to be seen if the Wrist PDA can become a success.

PlayStation 3, anyone?

Trust Sony to not rest on their laurels with the runaway success of the PlayStation 2. They've already started work on the third generation PlayStation keeping the future in mind. This next generation PlayStation, which is scheduled for launch in 2005, will be powered by an MPU (Microprocessing Unit), which will be around 200 times faster than current processors used in PCs and

game consoles. Sony will partner with Toshiba and IBM, and plans to spend \$400 million to develop this MPU.

Sony is betting heavily on the widespread usage of high-speed fibre-optic networks, as the new machine will have integrated support for such networks.

This is a radical design change that could eliminate the use of storage devices such as DVD drives.

Sony will also try and exploit the vast potential of online gaming and if they play their cards right, they can further secure their position as the number one console maker.

redalert

Bad music

Winamp version 2.79 has a bug which allows specially formed data tags in MP3 files to cause buffer overflows. This allows hackers to run pieces of code and access your computer. Such code can be embedded in the ID3v2 tag used in MP3 files.

When the file is played, Winamp tries to use its minibrowser with information from the tag to access the Winamp Web site. It's at this point that the buffer overflow takes place.

The bug spreads by altering ID3v2 tags of other MP3 files in your computer. Download the latest version of Winamp or disable Winamp's minibrowser to rectify this problem.

Danger chat

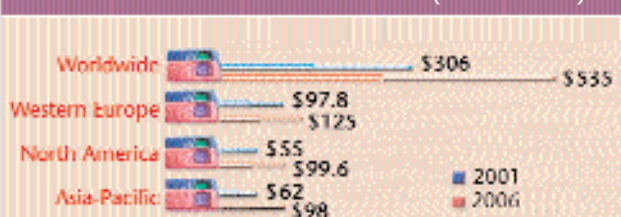
If you are using MSN Messenger versions 4.5 or 4.6, or Microsoft Exchange Instant Messenger 4.5 or 4.6, your system could be open to intruders. Older versions are safe as they do not have the buggy component called MSN Chat Control.

This component allows users to gather in a chat-room to chat with each other. A hacker can exploit the vulnerability here and cause buffer overruns to gain access to your computer.

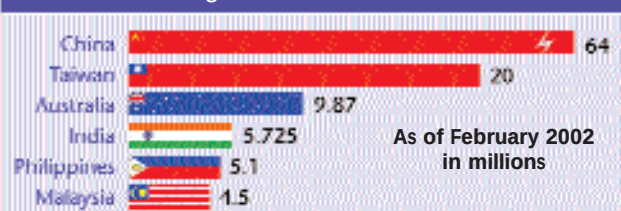
Protect yourself by downloading the latest chat control from the MSN site or by upgrading to the latest version of MSN Messenger or Microsoft Exchange Instant Messenger.

statattack

Worldwide mobile revenues (in billions)



Mobile usage in Asia-Pacific countries



INFOGRAPHICS: Jaya Shetty

snapshot

7,092,260

Internet users

in India

Number of Indian

Internet servers is

65,960

(May 2002)

Source: www.netsizer.com1

prices by over 10 per cent ■ Apple I computer sells for \$14,000 ■ Segway scooter inventor wins MIT prize ■ id Software officially announces Doom III